

theatre

Playful Act

DELHI With winter setting in, the Capital's theatre season has begun. Having entered its fifth year Matrix's The Old World Theatre Festival 2007 engages audiences at many levels. Seasoned directors, powerful performances and prize-winning scripts in critically acclaimed plays bring you the pick of 2007.

The festival also presents an opportunity to colleges in the Capital to present their productions. "The content, quality and competence of college theatre has grown from strength to strength, promising some excellent productions this time. History, comedy, dance and music and thought-provoking social and moral issues offer a wide ranging entertainment," says Vidyun Singh, director of programmes at Habitat World. The plays to be staged include Rukhsana Ahmad's new production, *Mistaken*, depicting the life of the founder of Theosophical Society, Annie Besant, and the forces which shaped her politics and passions. On December

3 and 4, Anosh Irani's *Bombay Black* directed by Anahita Uberoi will be staged. A tale of seduction, betrayal, revenge and love, it is as lyrical as is witty. On December 5 and 6, the musical *Razzmatazz*, featuring Sharon Prabhakar and Siddharth Meghani and eight dancers is sure to make your feet go tapping.

On December 7 and 8, Manav Kaul's original script *Ilham* dissects the human-self and enlightenment. On December 9 and 10, Raymond Daniel-Davies and Pat Boothman present Bernard Shaw's *Village Wooing* and *Pygmalion Not Likely* based on Richard Huggett's *The First Night of Pygmalion*. *Village Wooing* weaves in many of Shaw's favourite themes like the battle of the sexes and women's rights. On December 10, the comedy *Shaw Cornered* will be premiered at the festival. The finale on December 12 will be the famous play *Kanyadaan* written by Vijay Tendulkar. Directed by Lillete Dubey, it is the story of a daughter's transformation into a wife and a mother grappling with changing social barriers. At India Habitat Centre.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

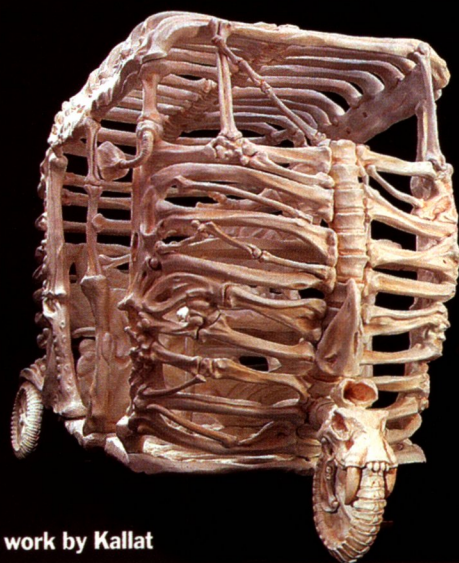
Sharon Prabhakar performing in the musical Razzmatazz



art exhibition

In Search of the Ideal

MUMBAI It has been three years since Jitish Kallat last held an exhibition in Mumbai. Kallat's recent work, a curious blend of pop and agitprop, addresses the classic themes of survival and the endless narratives of human struggle. The city, wherein the enterprise of daily existence is pushed to the extreme, acts as his artistic catalyst and continually percolates into his practice. "My work is a by-product of living in Mumbai; the pieces are an inevitable result of being touched by the themes that such a city throws at you," says Kallat. Conceived as a two-gallery project, Kallat's solo exhibition, *Sweatopia*, is being presented by Chemould Prescott Road and Bodhi Art Gallery. On display will be a collection of paintings, sculptures, drawings and large photographs. *Sweatopia* will bring together Kallat's new work made between 2005 and 2007, a period when his major pieces travelled to venues overseas but were not exhibited in India. See them from December 8 to January 8, 2008. by Swati Mathur



A work by Kallat

art

Illusions Unlimited

DELHI Rameshwar Broota's first solo digital photography show begins on December 5. Digital prints of images in their most potent forms will be displayed. Images bearing characteristics of photographic realism but with a complex narrative, which is apparently abstract on the surface. One

An image by Broota of the images is of a metal pot with its two outlets blocked by two human fingers, yet another one has the image of two human fingers animatedly merging with each other and creating an illusionary body. At Shridharani Art Gallery till December 15.

